

Tuesday, 7 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 31° 20°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 28° 18°	MANCHESTER Overcast 21° 16°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 18° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A jury has heard how a 16-year-old boy attacked his teacher with a large kitchen knife, with his face showing 'pure hatred'.

The court was told the teenager followed the teacher into a classroom before launching the terrifying assault. This shocking incident has raised serious concerns about school safety.

CRIME · UK
- 2

Four councillors have resigned from a Highland licensing committee after voting to let a rapist taxi driver keep his operator's licence.

The decision to allow David Brown to retain his licence sparked outrage and led to the resignations. This has ignited a debate about accountability and public trust in local governance.

JUSTICE · UK
- 3

New legislation, 'Benedict's Law', is set to overhaul school allergy training across the UK following a tragic death.

The law is named after Benedict Blythe, who died in 2021 after accidental exposure to an allergen at school. It aims to prevent similar tragedies by improving how schools manage severe allergies.

HEALTH · UK
- 4

Budget airline easyJet has agreed 'in principle' to a massive £5.2 billion takeover deal.

US investment firm Castlake had previously made four unsuccessful offers for the low-cost carrier. This significant acquisition could lead to big changes for the popular airline and its passengers.

BUSINESS · UK
- 5

The former Defence Secretary, John Healey, has claimed the Treasury views defence spending as a 'drain' rather than a 'driver for growth'.

Healey resigned from his cabinet role over long delays to military spending plans. His comments highlight ongoing tensions within government regarding national defence priorities and economic policy.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce have officially tied the knot in a star-studded New York City ceremony!**
The wedding, officiated by Adam Sandler, saw several Manhattan streets shut down for the celebrations. Fans and celebrities alike gathered to catch a glimpse of the A-list couple.
ON AIR – What's the most extravagant celebrity wedding you've ever heard of, or perhaps even dreamt of having yourself?
CELEBRITY · THIS WEEK
- 2 A new 'Reggae Walk of Fame' has been launched in Harlesden, celebrating the area's rich reggae heritage.**
The trail honours Windrush pioneers and key figures who shaped the vibrant music scene in north-west London. It's a fantastic way to recognise and preserve an important cultural legacy.
ON AIR – What music genre do you think deserves its own 'Walk of Fame' in the UK, and where should it be?
MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 3 ITV hits like 'I'm a Celebrity' are set to remain free to watch, even after Sky's proposed £1.6 billion takeover of ITV's media divisions.**
Sky boss Dana Strong confirmed the commitment as the acquisition deal was announced. It's good news for viewers who enjoy ITV's popular programming without a subscription.
ON AIR – If you could only pick one, which free-to-air TV show would you absolutely hate to see disappear behind a paywall?
TV · COMING UP
- 4 Screenwriter Russell T Davies has teased a brand new TV project, though he admits he 'doesn't know if it works' yet.**
The Swansea-born creator of 'Doctor Who' and 'It's a Sin' is known for pushing boundaries. Fans will be eagerly awaiting more details about his next potential hit.
ON AIR – Which TV writer or creator always gets you excited for their next project, no matter what it is?
TV · COMING UP
- 5 Harry Styles has officially received a Guinness World Record for the longest run of shows at Wembley Stadium!**
The 'Watermelon Sugar' singer is the first artist ever to perform 12 shows on a single tour at the iconic venue. It's a huge achievement for the global superstar.
ON AIR – If you could see any artist perform 12 times at Wembley, who would it be and why?
MUSIC · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **Relive all the drama from England's incredible 3-2 victory over Mexico, as they progressed to the World Cup quarter-finals.**

The Three Lions delivered one of their greatest away performances in a hostile Mexico City atmosphere. They now face Norway in what promises to be another thrilling encounter on Saturday.

ON AIR – After that epic win, how confident are you feeling about England's chances of going all the way in the World Cup?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Novak Djokovic has made Wimbledon history, breaking Roger Federer's all-time record for most men's singles match wins at the tournament.**

The Serb achieved the feat by beating qualifier Roman Safiullin to reach the quarter-finals. It's another incredible milestone for one of tennis's all-time greats.

ON AIR – Is Djokovic now definitively the greatest male tennis player of all time, or do you still lean towards Federer or Nadal?

TENNIS · UK

3 **England have named an unchanged side for their third T20 match against India today at Trent Bridge.**

The team will be hoping to continue their strong form in the series. It's a crucial match as they look to assert dominance against their rivals.

ON AIR – Are unchanged sides a sign of confidence or complacency in cricket, especially in a T20 series?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Tadej Pogacar has taken the yellow jersey at the Tour de France, winning a sweltering stage three with a late acceleration.**

The defending champion showed his class to claim victory and move into the overall lead. The race is already heating up in more ways than one!

ON AIR – If you could cycle any stage of the Tour de France, which one would you choose, and why?

CYCLING · UK

5 **Sale wing Tom Roebuck has been drafted into the England rugby squad amid a raft of injuries, particularly in the back-three.**

Roebuck's inclusion will help balance England's options as they navigate player absences. It's a big opportunity for the Sale star to make his mark.

ON AIR – How much impact do late injury call-ups typically have on a team's performance, especially in international rugby?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The humble art of letter writing is making a quiet comeback, offering a mindful alternative to instant messaging.**
Many are rediscovering the joy of putting pen to paper, finding that the personal touch of a handwritten note brings a special connection not found in digital communication.
- 2 British pet owners are increasingly sharing their snacks with their furry friends, especially during film nights.**
A recent informal poll suggests that popcorn and certain fruit slices are among the top treats carefully shared, provided they are pet-safe, of course!
- 3 A new trend sees people embracing 'slow cooking' as a way to unwind and enjoy the culinary process.**
Instead of quick meals, enthusiasts are dedicating time to simmering stews and roasting joints, savouring the aromas and the anticipation of a delicious result.
- 4 Gardeners are finding innovative ways to grow herbs indoors, making fresh flavours accessible all year round.**
From window boxes to vertical planters, basil, mint, and rosemary are thriving in kitchens, bringing a touch of green and a burst of taste to everyday cooking.
- 5 Researchers are noting the positive impact of 'nature journaling' on mental well-being.**
Taking time to observe and sketch local flora and fauna helps individuals connect with their surroundings and reduce stress, fostering a sense of calm.
- 6 The enduring popularity of 'jigsaw puzzles' is bringing families and friends together for screen-free entertainment.**
From intricate landscapes to colourful abstract designs, piecing together a puzzle offers a relaxing and collaborative activity for all ages.
- 7 An emerging trend sees people 'upcycling old furniture' to give it a new lease of life and unique character.**
Instead of buying new, renovators are transforming vintage pieces with paint, fabric, and a bit of creativity, adding a personal touch to their homes.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with their socks in the laundry basket, even if they know it doesn't really help?

ANSWER: TRYING TO PAIR THEM UP BEFORE WASHING, ONLY TO FIND THEY'RE STILL MISMATCHED AFTERWARDS!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'mug' that they absolutely have to use for their morning brew. What's special about it?

ANSWER: IT'S GOT A FUNNY SLOGAN, A HOLIDAY MEMORY, OR IT JUST 'FEELS RIGHT'!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old board game' from your childhood, and it's surprisingly fun to play again?**

What's that one classic game from your past that you've dug out recently and absolutely loved replaying? Let us know what made it so special!

- **We all have those 'little rituals' we do to make a cup of tea or coffee absolutely perfect, don't we?**

Whether it's the exact milk-to-sugar ratio, the order of ingredients, or a special stirring technique, what's your secret to the perfect cuppa?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins have a special gland that allows them to drink seawater and excrete the salt through their beaks.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The inventor of the Pringles can, Fredric Baur, was so proud of his design that he requested to be buried in one.
- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds.
- The world's smallest chameleon, *Brookesia nana*, is about the size of a sunflower seed.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- The sound of a whip cracking is actually a tiny sonic boom.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.

On this day

Day 188 of the year, 177 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æthelburh of Faremoutiers; Christian feast day: Felix of Nantes; Christian feast day: Illidius; Christian feast day: Job of Manyava (Ukrainian Orthodox Church). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1927 — Charlie Louvin, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 1981 — Synyster Gates, American guitarist
- 1959 — Billy Campbell, American actor
- 1941 — Jim Rodford, English bass player (died 2018)
- 1997 — James Marriott, English musician and online content creator
- 1944 — Tony Jacklin, English golfer and sportscaster
- 1930 — Hank Mobley, American saxophonist and composer (died 1986)
- 1972 — Kirsten Vangsness, American actress and writer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2003 — NASA Opportunity rover, MER-B or Mars Exploration Rover-B, was launched into space aboard a Delta II rocket.
- 1997 — The Turkish Armed Forces withdraw from northern Iraq after assisting the Kurdistan Democratic Party in the Iraqi Kurdish Civil War.
- 2017 — The Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons was adopted with 122 countries voting in favour.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The ocean liner SS United States passes Bishop Rock on her maiden voyage, breaking the transatlantic speed record to become the fastest passenger ship in the world.
- 1980 — During the Lebanese Civil War, 83 Tiger militants are killed during what will be known as the Safra massacre.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1959 — Venus occults the star Regulus. This rare event is used to determine the diameter of Venus and the structure of the Venusian atmosphere.
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1991 — Yugoslav Wars: The Brioni Agreement ends the ten-day independence war in Slovenia against the rest of the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia.

- 2017 — The Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons was adopted with 122 countries voting in favour.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 189 of the year, 176 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Abda and Sabas; Christian Feast Day: Auspicius of Trier; Christian Feast Day: Grimbald; Christian Feast Day: Landrada. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Pauline Quirke, English actress
- 1970 — Beck, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1963 — Mark Christopher, American director and screenwriter
- 1940 — Joe B. Mauldin, American bass player and songwriter (died 2015)
- 1961 — Andrew Fletcher, English keyboard player (died 2022)
- 1998 — Jaden Smith, American actor and rapper
- 1944 — Jaimoe, American drummer
- 1952 — Larry Garner, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1966 — King Mwambutsa IV Bangiriceng of Burundi is deposed by his son Prince Charles Ndizi.
- 2022 — Former Japanese prime minister Shinzo Abe is shot and killed with an improvised firearm due to resentment against the Unification Church.
- 1912 — Henrique Mitchell de Paiva Couceiro leads an unsuccessful royalist attack against the First Portuguese Republic in Chaves.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1970 — Richard Nixon delivers a special congressional message enunciating Native American self-determination as official US Indian policy, leading to the Indian Self-Determination and Education Assistance Act of 1975.
- 1982 — A failed assassination attempt against Iraqi president Saddam Hussein results in the Dujail Massacre over the next several months.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026		AUGUST 2026	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn	FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off	FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU	FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day	FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites		
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot		
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2		
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)		
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller		
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)		

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)